

Driver is indicted in fatal school bus crash

Faces three charges in death of kindergartner

By John Hilliard, Lea Skene, and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

The driver of a Boston Public Schools bus that struck and killed a 5-year-old in Hyde Park last April was charged Wednesday in the death of the kindergartner.

Jean Charles, 39, of Brockton, was charged with involuntary manslaughter, reckless motor vehicular homicide, and negligent motor vehicle homicide, Suffolk District Attorney Kevin R. Hayden's office said in a statement. Charles is scheduled to be arraigned March 26.

Charles was behind the wheel when Lens Arthur Joseph, a student at UP Academy in Dorchester, was fatally struck the in the street outside his home. This same school bus that had just seconds earlier dropped off Lens and his cousin.

Lens's family on Wednesday took some comfort in the criminal justice system's efforts to hold the driver responsible for his actions, but didn't celebrate the news, according to the family's attorney, Matthew Fogelman.

"There's some measure of relief, although obviously this is only the first step in that process," Fogelman said.

The death of kindergartner on a city street
BUS DRIVER, Page A7

Beth Israel Lahey CEO to step down

Steered hospital system to financial stability

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

The head of Beth Israel Lahey Health, Dr. Kevin Tabb, announced Wednesday his plans to step aside in a year from the state's second-largest hospital system, saying the time had come for fresh energy atop the organization.

Tabb, 62, said he's not yet retiring, but feels the time is right to announce his intention to leave, after having steered the hospital system through the pandemic and to financial stability. The CEO, who has led the organization for 14 years, will leave Beth Israel Lahey Health on the heels of a successful stretch, but also in the midst of tremendous change within the organization, as well as the industry. Construction of a new cancer hospital with Dana-Farber Cancer Institute is about to break ground and looming federal health care cuts have contributed to a number of headwinds confronting medical providers of all sizes.

Under Tabb's leadership, the system ran a \$100 million operating gain last year — the first in the black in four years. And in an employee survey last spring, a majority of respondents said they were happy working for the organization and would recommend the company. Tabb also made a mark on the recruiting front, with Beth Israel adding dozens of primary care clini-

TAPP, Page A10

Conflict spreads past Mideast



VAHID SALEMI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A man carried an Iranian flag to place on the rubble of a police facility struck in Tehran on Wednesday.

REPRESENTATIVE JIM MCGOVERN, MASSACHUSETTS DEMOCRAT



'I disagree with those who, you know, think the only fault here is that Donald Trump didn't ask permission. I think the Democratic Party ought to be the party that opposes war.'

REPRESENTATIVE MAGGIE GOODLANDER, NEW HAMPSHIRE DEMOCRAT



'This isn't a process concern alone — I mean, this is a constitutional requirement. It's also strategically wise, because we make better decisions when the president is forced to answer to Congress and when Congress does its job.'

Democrats push back on lack of congressional input — and war itself

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — For Democrats, President Trump's decision to attack Iran isn't just a full-blown crisis.

It's also forcing them into serious soul-searching about what the party stands for in this fraught moment, as the first votes of the 2026 midterm elections are cast.

The vast majority of Democratic lawmakers are outraged and alarmed that Trump moved unilaterally to launch a large-scale military assault on Iran without any congressional input or authorization — much less any serious effort to make the case to the American public.

Many Democratic Party leaders, like Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer, seized first on Trump's disrespect for the protocol around going

to war in their early statements on the emerging conflict.

But for some in the party, largely in the progressive wing, the greater outrage is that the US is involved in a new foreign war, period — not that Trump has neglected longstanding standards for American presidents weighing military action.

Representative Jim McGovern, the Massachusetts Democrat, said that his colleagues' concerns about Trump's process are "legitimate" but added, "this isn't just about process."

"I disagree with those who, you know, think the only fault here is that Donald Trump didn't ask permission," McGovern told the Globe. "I think the Democratic Party ought to be the party that opposes war."

DEMOCRATS, Page A6

US sub hits Iranian ship off Sri Lanka; NATO defenses take down missile

By Eric Schmitt, Helene Cooper, Lara Jakes, and Michael Levenson
NEW YORK TIMES

The 5-day-old war with Iran spread far beyond the Middle East on Wednesday as an American submarine torpedoed an Iranian navy ship off Sri Lanka and NATO air defenses shot down an Iranian ballistic missile that was heading toward Turkish airspace.

The Iranian warship, the IRIS Dena, with a crew of 180, sank in international waters in the Indian Ocean, more than 2,000 miles from Iran. The Sri Lankan navy rescued 32 critically injured sailors and was searching for more survivors but had encountered only bodies floating in the water near an oil slick and empty lifeboats, a spokesperson said.

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth said it was the first time a US submarine had fired a torpedo at a ship since World War II. But it was NATO's introduction into the conflict that made clear the widening scope of the fight.

"Iran is broadening the war to countries that did not attack it," Radoslaw Sikorski, the Polish foreign affairs minister, said at a news conference with European Union leaders in Warsaw, Poland. He said, "There is a well-known saying: It's worse than a crime; it's a mistake."

In Washington, Senate Republicans on Wednesday blocked a measure that would have limited President Trump's power to continue the war against Iran without congressio-

IRAN, Page A4

R.I. report says diocese did not protect children



CHARLES KRUPA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Cathedral of Saints Peter and Paul is the home church of the Roman Catholic Diocese of Providence.

AG: Suspected priests were only transferred

By Amanda Milkovits, Edward Fitzpatrick, and Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — The Roman Catholic Diocese of Providence failed for decades to protect hundreds of children from clergy sexual abuse, and handled accusations of misconduct through "inaction, concealment, and revictimization," according to an investigation released Wednesday by the attorney general's office and Rhode Island State Police.

The investigation identified 75 clergy, including 61 who were diocesan priests or deacons, 13

religious order priests, and an extern priest who were credibly accused of abusing more than 300 children between 1950 and 2011.

When church higherups — including bishops — suspected or became aware of abuse, the diocese regularly protected the accused priests, transferring them to new and unsuspecting congregations where they continued to have access to children, the report said. The diocese also minimized complaints of child sexual abuse and routinely advocated for priests who were criminally charged.

"Generations of Rhode Island victims, their families, and others who have suffered the impacts of this trauma deserve to know the truth of what oc-

ABUSE, Page A10

Dozens of medical schools will rework their curriculums to teach more about nutrition, under pressure from Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. **A2.**

An independent researcher claimed that a marble bust of Christ in a Roman church is by Michelangelo, the latest purported attribution to the Renaissance genius. **A3.**

Wearables startup Whoop in Boston said it intends to hire 600 more employees in 2026, coming close to doubling its workforce in just one year. **D1.**

Massachusetts is poised to become the next state to pilot an expanded genomic screening study that could identify hundreds of rare diseases in newborns. **B1.**



Reality shows

Thursday: Cooler, drizzly. High: 38-43. Low: 31-36.

Friday: Messy morning. High: 36-41. Low: 32-37.

Sunrise: 6:13 Sunset: 5:39
Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 309, NO. 64

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00

